

IMAGE PROMPTS — VISUAL REFERENCE

5 Ways Your Brain Physically Rewires Itself to Stay Broke (Without Telling You)

104 beats · 4 parts of ~26 beats · Visual-first (no redundant text labels)

STYLE PREAMBLE — prepend to every prompt in Google Flow:

2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720.

IMAGE PROMPTS — PART 1/4 (Beats 1–26)

■■ HOOK ■■

BEAT 1 *"Alex earns more than he did three years ago. He has less to show for it."*

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BEAT 2 *"Not bad investments."*

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BEAT 3 *"Not unexpected expenses."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex close-up, eyes directed UP AND RIGHT (searching direction). Slight headshake implied by posture. Clean white background. No props.

BEAT 4 *"Five programs he was never told about."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex's transparent skull shown prominently. Inside: five distinct glowing circuits arranged around the Brain Villain — each circuit a different color node connected by thin electric lines. Villain stands at center, arms crossed, expression smug. Alex expression: neutral outside, unaware. White background.

BEAT 5 *"Programs that physically alter the architecture of his brain."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up cross-section of stylized cartoon brain. Five separate red circuit paths etched into the surface like carved grooves — thick, structural, permanent-looking. No text labels on circuits. White background. Anatomical diagram style, flat cartoon.

BEAT 6 "The third one gets worse the more educated he becomes."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex standing beside a rising graduation-cap icon and open book stack. The third glowing circuit inside his skull grows BRIGHTER and thicker as the book stack gets taller. Alex's expression: confident smile — unaware. Irony visual. No text labels.

BEAT 7 "We are going to show you all five."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex facing viewer directly, calm and confident. His transparent skull shows all five circuits lit, Brain Villain visible at center. Alex's posture: open, welcoming — like beginning a guided tour. White background.

BEAT 8 "The order matters. Trap One fires first."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. A horizontal sequence of five numbered circles (1–5) connected by arrows — like a chain reaction diagram. Circle 1 is red and pulsing. Circles 2–5 are grey/dormant. Alex stands beside the chain, pointing at circle 1. White background.

BEAT 9 "Your brain started running it this week."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex's Brain Villain inside skull at a small control panel — one lever pulled DOWN (active). Digital clock in corner shows CURRENT DAY icon (mid-week). Villain expression: satisfied smirk. Alex exterior expression: unaware. Close-up on skull.

BEAT 10 "Wednesday afternoon. He has not been paid."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex at desk, mid-week. Calendar on wall — Wednesday circled in neutral blue. Salary notification icon in corner greyed out (not arrived yet). Alex posture: relaxed, slightly idle. Neutral mood.

BEAT 11 "He already knows what he will buy — the jacket, the dinner, the upgrade."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Thought bubble above Alex's head containing three icons: leather jacket silhouette, fork-and-plate icon, smartphone with upgrade arrow. Thought bubble is vivid and colorful. Alex's expression: light anticipatory smile. No text labels on the icons.

BEAT 12 "His brain made those decisions forty-eight hours before his salary existed."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Timeline arrow: LEFT — 'Wednesday' marker (Alex with thought bubble). RIGHT — 'Friday' marker (salary envelope icon). A dotted decision line starts at Wednesday, BEFORE the salary arrives. Red dot marks when brain committed. White background, diagram style.

■■ TRAP 1: ANTICIPATION BURN ■■

BEAT 13 "Wolfram Schultz. Cambridge University. Nobel Prize in Medicine."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Clean institutional label card: 'WOLFRAM SCHULTZ / CAMBRIDGE' in bold black block letters. Small brain icon beside name. White background. No photo — text IS the prop here.

BEAT 14 "Dopamine does not fire when you receive a reward. It fires when you predict one."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Two-panel diagram. LEFT: monkey reaching for reward, dopamine bar LOW. RIGHT: same monkey seeing a SIGNAL that reward is coming — dopamine bar HIGH, red/orange spike. Arrow between panels labeled with small clock icon (timing). No text labels on bars.

BEAT 15 "Wednesday peak. Friday declining signal."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Dopamine curve graph: rises sharply at 'WED' marker on x-axis, begins declining through 'THU', lower at 'FRI'. Green highlight at peak, fading to neutral. No text on y-axis. Small Alex figure stands under the Wednesday peak, looking satisfied.

BEAT 16 "By Friday, the spending is just a receipt. The decision was made on Wednesday."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex on Friday, tapping phone to complete a purchase. Expression: slightly flat, automatic. Shadow of his Wednesday self (vivid, excited) looms behind him. Receipt icon appears in hand. No text. Visual: past self made this choice.

BEAT 17 "His brain spent the money before the salary existed."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Bank balance bar. LEFT: empty (pre-salary). RIGHT: salary arrives, but three purchase arrows immediately drain it — jacket, dinner, upgrade icons flowing out automatically. The drain arrows were ALREADY DRAWN in dotted lines before the salary bar filled. Automatic. White background.

BEAT 18 "This is not a character flaw. This is a mechanism."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex looking directly at viewer. Expression: calm, knowing. No props. Clean white background. Inside his skull: the Brain Villain running the anticipation circuit — mechanical, not malicious. Villain expression: neutral, operational.

BEAT 19 "It runs in every brain."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Three different silhouette figures (different heights, professions implied by clothing icons) — all three with transparent skulls showing the same Trap 1 circuit pattern glowing identically. White background. Universal mechanism visual.

BEAT 20 "Trap One feeds directly into Trap Two."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. The horizontal chain diagram from Beat 8 — now circles 1 and 2 are both red and lit. Arrow between 1 and 2 is thick and glowing. Alex beside the chain, expression shifting from mild concern to something quieter.

BEAT 21 "Saturday morning. Alex does not check his balance."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex in bed, phone face-down on nightstand. Calendar shows SATURDAY. Balance notification icon on phone screen (face-down, invisible to Alex). Alex expression: eyes closed or looking away. The phone screen glows faintly, unseen.

BEAT 22 "He will check next week."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Same scene. Alex now at kitchen table, coffee in hand. Phone still face-down nearby. A small thought bubble: calendar with next week indicated by faint arrow. Expression: vague, non-committal. Brain Villain in skull: satisfied, reclining.

BEAT 23 "Thirty-day balance check pattern — six checks after paycheck, zero after purchases."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Bar chart calendar — 30 day strip. First 6 days: tall green bars (checks). Days 7–30: flat zero bars. Small purchase icons appear on days 7–10 where the bars drop to zero. Pattern is stark and visual. White background. No axis text labels.

BEAT 24 "Galai and Sade. Hebrew University. Two thousand and six."

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BEAT 25 "They called it the ostrich effect."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex with head turned away from a glowing phone screen showing a falling red bar chart. Alex's eyes deliberately averted. Brain Villain inside skull: covering villain's own eyes with tiny hands, expression theatrical but deliberate. Ostrich-pose implied without literal ostrich. White background.

BEAT 26 "Painful information — the brain stops seeking it."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Diagram: LEFT — red painful data icon (downward arrow, red). RIGHT — brain circuit with a literal OFF switch flicking to OFF position. Arrow between them shows causation. No text labels on the mechanism. Small Alex silhouette in background, turned away.

PART 1 DONE — Beats 1–26 ✓

IMAGE PROMPTS — PART 2/4 (Beats 27–52)

BEAT 27 *"Not a choice. A conditioned reflex that reduces cortisol."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Two-stage diagram: Stage 1 — red data icon triggers pain signal (jagged line). Stage 2 — avoidance behavior flattens the pain signal (smooth line). Automatic arrow between stages. Alex silhouette at far right, cortisol level bar dropping from red to neutral. No text on the bars.

BEAT 28 *"Every bad number that was seen became a pain point recorded."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Timeline strip with small red exclamation icons at irregular intervals — each one a financial pain moment. Alex at far right of the timeline, posture slightly hunched, accumulated weight of the timeline pressing on him. Visual: learned aversion.

BEAT 29 *"The avoidance became automatic."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. The same phone screen from Beat 21 now appears TWICE — Week 1 (Alex briefly looks, turns away) and Week 4 (Alex does not even glance, phone completely ignored). Arrow between panels shows time. Automaticity is the story.

BEAT 30 *"Money leaves. Alex does not see it."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex standing in room. Multiple small money icons (coins, notes) flow out through a door behind him — steady stream. Alex faces the opposite direction, completely unaware. The drain is silent, invisible to him. White background.

BEAT 31 *"Trap One runs undisturbed. And Trap Three gives it a vocabulary."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. The chain diagram: circles 1, 2, 3 now connected and lit in sequence. Circle 3 has a small book icon above it — vocabulary/expertise. Alex beside chain, expression: unaware but confident. Building tension.

■■■ CTA ■■■

BEAT 32 *"If your brain is doing this to you right now — subscribe."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex turned toward viewer, direct expression, slightly urgent. Inside skull: Brain Villain holds up a small STOP sign (the Villain trying to prevent the subscribe). Below Alex: clean red subscribe button icon, minimal style. White background.

BEAT 33 "We break down a new bias every week. It's free. And it might save you more than you think."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Subscribe button large and centered, Alex standing beside it with arm around it (friendly). Brain Villain inside skull: arms crossed, pouting — disapproves of this CTA. Alex expression: warmly direct. White background.

■■ TRAP 3: EXPERTISE TRAP ■■

BEAT 34 "Alex has been reading behavioral finance."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex at desk, thick book open, title spine shows small brain icon (no specific title text). Multiple sticky notes around desk with concept words visible — but not repeated from narration. Use abstract squiggles or icons on sticky notes, not words. Alex expression: engaged, studious.

BEAT 35 "Vocabulary is floating around his head — he has a language for what is happening."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex with thought cloud surrounding his head containing floating abstract concept shapes — geometric icons suggesting mental models (triangle, gear, node-web, loop arrow). These are icons, NOT text labels. Alex expression: satisfied, equipped.

BEAT 36 "Alex feels confident. Arms crossed. He has got this."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex in confident pose: arms crossed firmly, chin slightly raised, half-smile. Inside skull: Brain Villain mimics the pose but with an even more exaggerated smirk. White background. Both postures identical — one unaware the other is doing it too.

BEAT 37 "Terrance Odean. University of California Berkeley."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Clean institutional label card: 'TERRANCE ODEAN / UC BERKELEY' in bold black. Small downward chart line icon — minimal. White background.

BEAT 38 "He studied investors who traded more frequently. They earned lower returns."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Two investor figures side by side. LEFT: low-activity investor (few trade arrows), green returns bar: tall. RIGHT: high-activity investor (many trade arrows flying around), returns bar: lower, red tint. Activity does not equal performance. No text labels on bars.

BEAT 39 "The confidence had outpaced the competence."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Split vertical bar chart: CONFIDENCE bar (left, rising steeply, blue) vs COMPETENCE bar (right, rising slowly, green). Confidence bar is clearly taller. Gap between them is highlighted with a red bracket. Alex tiny figure stands on top of the confidence bar, looking down at the gap. No text labels.

BEAT 40 "Kahneman. Eighty percent of people believe they are above-average drivers."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Large bold numeral '80%' centered. Below: row of ten simple car icons — eight highlighted blue (believe above-average), two grey (accurate). Alex among the eight highlighted, expression confident. No 'Daniel Kahneman' text — just '80%' as the prop.

BEAT 41 "Fifty percent are mathematically wrong."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Same row of ten car icons. Now five highlighted cars have a subtle red tint overlay — these are the ones who were wrong. Alex is in the red-tinted group. Expression: unchanged. Still confident. That is the point.

BEAT 42 "More vocabulary leads to more certainty — not more accuracy."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Two parallel arrows rising from left to right. TOP arrow: rising with book icons along it (vocabulary accumulating). BOTTOM arrow: rises much more slowly with target-hit icons (accuracy). The gap between the two arrows WIDENS as they move right. No text labels.

BEAT 43 "Alex has the vocabulary. His chart is still flat."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Split image: LEFT — Alex with floating concept-shape cloud around head (from Beat 35). RIGHT — a flat grey savings/portfolio line chart, no growth. The vocabulary and the outcome are visually disconnected. Alex looks between them with mild confusion.

BEAT 44 "Certainty and accuracy are not the same variable."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Two simple meters side by side: LEFT meter labeled with a lock icon (certainty — needle at maximum). RIGHT meter labeled with a target icon (accuracy — needle at medium). Same visual format, different readings. Gap is the story. No text labels on needles.

BEAT 45 "Alex in the mirror — confident posture — empty wallet shadow on the wall."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex standing in front of mirror. His reflection shows the confident arms-crossed pose. But his SHADOW on the wall behind him shows a deflated silhouette, wallet icon empty. The shadow tells a different story than the reflection. High contrast.

BEAT 46 "The certainty-accuracy gap is Trap Three."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Clean diagram: two labeled boxes — one with lock icon (certainty), one with target icon (accuracy) — connected by a dotted line showing the gap. Red bracket highlights the space between them. Alex's tiny figure stands in the gap, looking up at both boxes. White background.

■■ TRAP 4: NIGHT DRAIN ■■

BEAT 47 *"Trap Three flows directly into Trap Four."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. The chain diagram: circles 1, 2, 3, 4 now all lit in sequence. Circle 4 glows with a moon/night icon above it. Connection arrows between all four are solid red. Alex beside the chain, expression showing dawning awareness.

BEAT 48 *"Ten forty-seven PM. Tuesday. Alex is tired at his desk."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex slumped slightly at desk, posture lower than earlier beats. Clock on wall or corner: 10:47 PM. Single lamp light pools warm on the desk. Eyes slightly heavy. Brain Villain inside skull: alert, upright — inverse of Alex's tired posture.

BEAT 49 *"He adds something to his cart. He is not fully sure. He buys it anyway."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Phone screen close-up: shopping cart icon with item silhouette. Alex's finger hovers over BUY button — small pause visual (thought bubble with question mark). Next: finger taps. Confirmation icon appears. The moment of unclear purchase.

BEAT 50 *"Shai Danziger. Ben-Gurion University of the Negev."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Clean institutional label card: 'SHAI DANZIGER / BEN-GURION UNIVERSITY' in bold black. Small gavel icon — judicial context. White background.

BEAT 51 *"Eight judges. Ten months. Every parole hearing they conducted."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Eight silhouette judge figures in a row, small and formal. Timeline beneath them spanning ten months. Stack of case files beside each figure — emphasizing volume. White background. No text labels.

BEAT 52 *"Morning: sixty-five percent of parole requests granted."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Bar chart — MORNING section: tall green bar reaching 65% level. Gavel icon at base. Judge silhouette alert and upright. Sun icon in corner. No percentage text on bar — the height tells the story.

PART 2 DONE — Beats 27–52 ✓

IMAGE PROMPTS — PART 3/4 (Beats 53–78)

BEAT 53 "Afternoon: eleven percent. Same evidence. Same judges."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Same bar chart — AFTERNOON section added: dramatically short red bar, 11% level. Same gavel icon at base. Judge silhouette slumped slightly. Sun lower in corner. The contrast between morning and afternoon bars is stark. Same evidence — different outcome.

BEAT 54 "Alex at nine AM — alert, wallet closed. Alex at ten PM — glazed, wallet open."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Side-by-side comparison. LEFT — Alex 9 AM: upright posture, eyes clear, wallet in pocket closed, phone face-down. RIGHT — Alex 10 PM: posture lower, eyes slightly glazed, wallet open on desk, phone in hand with cart icon glowing. Same person, different capacity.

BEAT 55 "Decision depletion. A declining curve from morning to night."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Line chart: x-axis shows time (morning to night with sun/moon icons). Y-axis: decision quality implied by curve height. Curve starts HIGH at morning, steadily declines, reaches LOW at night. No numbers on axes. Alex tiny figure stands under the declining curve at evening position.

BEAT 56 "Ten PM plus shopping cart equals depleted battery."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Simple equation visual: clock showing 10 PM icon + shopping cart icon = depleted battery icon (red, nearly empty). Alex beside the equation, expression connecting the dots. White background. Icons tell the whole story.

BEAT 57 "Alex clicks purchase. Brain Villain was waiting for exactly this moment."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex's hand clicking phone screen. Inside skull: Brain Villain at the controls, expression shifts to ALERT and excited the moment the click happens. Villain had been waiting — posture goes from reclining to upright. The trap fires.

BEAT 58 "The Villain does not attack. It simply reclines and waits."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Brain Villain inside Alex's skull: reclining in a tiny armchair, heavy-lidded eyes half closed, arms behind head. Expression: patient, unhurried. This is waiting, not hunting. The patience is the point. White background. Alex exterior: unaware.

BEAT 59 "Battery at zero. Tuesday night."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Full scene: Alex slumped at desk, phone glowing in hand, purchase confirmation on screen. Bottom corner: battery icon at 0% with red empty indicator. Calendar: TUESDAY NIGHT. Lamp still on. The whole scene conveys depletion without drama.

■■ TRAP 5: UPGRADE LOCK ■■

BEAT 60 "All four gears are now meshing together."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Four interlocking gears, each with a subtle circuit node or icon representing each trap (anticipation wave, eye-averted, book/brain gap, moon/battery). All four spinning in coordination. Alex outside the gear system, watching it run. Mechanical and inevitable.

BEAT 61 "Alex can see the machine from outside."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex standing back, looking at the four-gear system from a distance. Expression: recognition. He is seeing it for the first time from outside. Small spotlight illuminates the machine. White background. This is the moment of awareness.

BEAT 62 "Six months ago — Alex pointing at his apartment, satisfied."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex in front of a modest apartment building icon, pointing at it with pride. Expression: content, pleased. Thought bubble: simple green heart or checkmark. This was enough. Warm, simple scene.

BEAT 63 "Satisfaction meter full — then declining over eleven days."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Calendar strip: 11 days shown left to right. Day 1: satisfaction meter (vertical bar) fully green. Day 6: medium green. Day 11: bar down to 20%, nearly empty. Same apartment icon at bottom, unchanged. The apartment did not change — only the meter did.

BEAT 64 "Day eleven. Satisfaction at twenty percent. Same apartment."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex now looking at the same apartment from Beat 62 — but posture is different: slightly deflated, eyes scanning for something better. Apartment unchanged. Satisfaction bar in corner: 20%. The shift is internal, not external.

BEAT 65 "Kent Berridge. University of Michigan. Thirty years separating two words."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Clean institutional label card: 'KENT BERRIDGE / UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN' in bold black. Below: two simple word-cards side by side — 'WANTING' and 'LIKING' with a gap/arrow between them showing they are NOT the same. White background.

BEAT 66 "Wanting and liking are not the same circuit."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Brain cross-section diagram showing two distinct circuit paths. LEFT circuit: yellow/orange glow — WANTING path (dopamine arrows). RIGHT circuit: soft green glow — LIKING path. Clear visual separation. Different colors, different shapes. No text labels on the circuits.

BEAT 67 "Wanting is the dopamine system — it grows with every upgrade."

Image Prompt: 2D cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. WANTING circuit from Beat 66, now isolated. Dopamine arrow icons growing larger with each frame — the signal amplifies. Each upgrade icon (phone, apartment, car silhouette) adds another larger dopamine arrow. The system feeds itself.

BEAT 68 "Liking stays flat."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. LIKING circuit: a flat green line, static. Upgrade icons pass by (phone, apartment, car) but the flat line does not rise. Contrast with the growing WANTING arrows. Two circuits side by side — one growing, one flat. The mismatch is everything.

BEAT 69 "Every upgrade raises the wanting. The liking stays the same."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex on a simple rising staircase: each step is an upgrade (small phone → big phone → basic apartment → nicer apartment). At each step, small WANTING arrows grow larger. Small LIKING meter beside him stays at same level across all steps. No text labels.

BEAT 70 "Alex wants more. But the liking circuit gets smaller."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex at current step on the staircase. WANTING: large arrows. LIKING: meter now slightly SMALLER than before. The liking shrinks as wanting grows — Brian downregulation visualized. Alex expression: restless, not satisfied despite having more.

BEAT 71 "Staircase of apartments — basic, good, better, best. Alex at each step with the same expression."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Four-panel staircase: basic studio → one-bedroom → two-bedroom → penthouse. Alex stands at each level with IDENTICAL neutral expression. The apartments get better, he feels the same. Visual: hedonic adaptation. No text labels on apartments.

BEAT 72 "The brain downregulates — fewer receptors after repetition."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Microscopic-style diagram: LEFT — many receptor icons densely packed (before upgrade). RIGHT — fewer receptor icons, more spaced out (after repetition). Clean, iconic. No text labels. The visual says: the system reduces its own sensitivity.

BEAT 73 "The floor keeps rising. There is no ceiling visible."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex's staircase from Beat 69: the floor level (bottom of frame) rises with each step, compressing the space below. Above Alex: no ceiling visible, just open space suggesting infinite more steps. The trap has no top. White background.

BEAT 74 "Alex is satisfied for a moment — then looking upward."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex at current step: brief moment of satisfaction (expression: small content smile). Next instant: eyes shift upward toward next step, expression becomes restless. Two micro-expressions in sequence on same figure.

BEAT 75 "Biological compound interest — the circuit grows but remains trapped in the loop."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Circular loop arrow (perpetual motion diagram) with a growing bar chart inside the loop — the circuit gets stronger but goes nowhere. Green color for the growth, trapped inside a red circular boundary. Alex tiny figure running inside the loop.

■■ SYSTEM CLOSE ■■

BEAT 76 "All five are running simultaneously."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Five interlocking gears, each now active (circuit icons, colored nodes). All five spinning in coordinated motion. Larger than the four-gear diagram from Beat 60. The full machine revealed. White background. No text labels on gears.

BEAT 77 "Alex sees the machine from outside."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex standing at a distance from the five-gear system. Expression: recognition and clarity — this is the moment he sees it. Small spotlight from above. The machine is separate from him, observable. This beat is about awareness, not despair.

BEAT 78 "Five programs. Five gears. All running."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. The five gears labeled with small icons only (no text): 1-anticipation wave, 2-averted eye, 3-book/gap, 4-moon battery, 5-staircase loop. Each icon is distinct and instantly readable. White background. Clean diagram.

PART 3 DONE — Beats 53–78 ✓

IMAGE PROMPTS — PART 4/4 (Beats 79–104)

BEAT 79 "Trap One feeds into Trap Two."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Flow diagram: large circle with anticipation-wave icon → arrow → large circle with averted-eye icon. Arrow is thick, red, directional. Alex tiny figure in background, unaware. The causation chain is being built step by step.

BEAT 80 "Trap Two feeds into Trap Three. Alex cannot see the balance — so he invests more confidence."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Flow diagram continues: averted-eye circle → arrow → book/gap circle. Alex in background: eyes averted from balance data, but posture is confident, arms crossed. The blindness fuels the overconfidence. Visual causation.

BEAT 81 "Trap Three leads to Trap Four. The expertise feeds the evening confidence."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Flow: book/gap circle → arrow → moon/battery circle. Alex with vocabulary-concept cloud from earlier now shown at his desk at 10 PM — the confidence persists into tired hours. The expertise trick makes him trust his depleted judgment.

BEAT 82 "Trap Four connects to Trap Five. The depleted brain reaches for the next upgrade."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Flow: moon/battery circle → arrow → staircase-loop circle. Alex at 10 PM, depleted, clicking purchase for the next upgrade. The depleted state makes the upgrade feel necessary. Full chain connection visual.

BEAT 83 "The system runs at forty thousand and at a hundred and forty thousand. Same percentage draining."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Two income columns side by side: '€40K' and '€140K' (text IS the prop here — specific numbers). Both columns show identical percentage drain: same proportion of money flowing out through five small arrows (one per trap). Income changes, drain rate does not. White background.

BEAT 84 "The math adjusts. The programs do not."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Two equations side by side — visually identical structure, different numbers. Both equal the same drain percentage. The equivalence is the point. Alex stands between them, expression: understanding. Clean white background, diagram style.

■■ BRAIN VILLAIN'S LAST TRICK ■■

BEAT 85 "The Brain Villain has one response to all five."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Brain Villain inside skull, holding up one finger — making a point. Expression: deliberate, strategic. Smug but not aggressive. Alex exterior: neutral. The Villain is about to deploy its final move. Close-up on skull.

BEAT 86 "You are feeling it right now."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex looking at a screen (self-referential — he is the viewer). Inside his skull: Brain Villain also looking at the same screen direction, smirk widening. Both watching simultaneously. The Villain is aware the viewer is being addressed. Fourth wall moment.

BEAT 87 "Not anxiety. Something quieter."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex close-up: expression subtly smug, slightly closed-off. NOT anxious or stressed — something like quiet self-assurance. This is the Expertise Trap deploying in real time. The expression is the story. White background.

BEAT 88 "Something that sounds like wisdom: I already know this."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Thought bubble above Alex: 'I already know this.' — text in speech bubble IS the prop here. Brain Villain inside skull: smiling, approving the thought, nodding. The Villain loves this particular defense mechanism. No other text.

BEAT 89 "That thought is not wisdom."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Same thought bubble — 'I already know this.' — now with a thick red X drawn through it. Brain Villain's smile fading slightly. Alex expression beginning to shift — cracks in the certainty. The reframe begins.

BEAT 90 "It is the Expertise Trap wearing the costume of wisdom."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Brain Villain wearing a tiny graduation cap, holding a small scroll — dressed as wisdom. But behind the Villain: the Trap 3 (book/gap) circuit is highlighted and glowing. The costume does not hide the mechanism. Alex looks at the Villain with recognition.

BEAT 91 "Identifying the five programs does not turn them off."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. All five gear circuits in Alex's skull — still glowing, still running, after identification. Alex's expression: calm acceptance (not distress). The gears are not stopped by being named. This is honest and important. White background.

BEAT 92 "Your ancestors in an environment where anticipation meant survival."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Simplified flat cartoon — ancient landscape: campfire, distant predator silhouette in trees. Ancestor figure (simplified Alex design, primitive clothing) with anticipation circuit glowing bright — spotting a threat early. The circuit was adaptive. Warm amber light.

BEAT 93 "Naming the predator did not make it stop moving."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Same ancestor scene: thought bubble above ancestor — predator silhouette (the name). But predator still advancing from trees. Naming ≠ stopping. Visual parallel to knowing the bias but still experiencing it. Simple and clear.

BEAT 94 "The Brain Villain was built for that world. Not this one."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Split panel: LEFT — Brain Villain in prehistoric setting, campfire glow, looking content and well-suited. RIGHT — same Brain Villain in modern city background, modern apartment icons, looking slightly out of place but still operational. The mismatch is visual.

■■ IDENTITY CLOSE ■■

BEAT 95 "Next video: one decision. Set up on a calm Tuesday. No motivation required."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Preview frame: calendar showing TUESDAY (circled, calm blue). A single clean transfer arrow icon. Alex pointing forward toward next video. Small '1 DECISION' text on the calendar (text IS the prop). Expression: forward-looking, calm.

BEAT 96 "Alex in clean white space — neutral clear expression. No villain visible."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex centered, clean white background, calm neutral expression — not triumphant, not worried. His skull is visible but circuits are quiet (dim, not dark). Brain Villain is present but subdued. This is clarity, not victory.

BEAT 97 "The programs are not broken. They are perfectly designed for an environment where early signals meant survival."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Campfire icon scene — ancestor with anticipation circuit, alert and alive. The circuit SAVED him then. Warm, humanizing light. The narrative: these programs were correct once. No judgment. Evolutionary context without drama.

BEAT 98 "One structural decision bypasses all five."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Clean bank diagram: one automatic transfer arrow — BANK ACCOUNT → SAVINGS. Single clean movement. The five gear circuits visible in a small inset corner, but the arrow bypasses all of them. Structural solution, not willpower. White background.

BEAT 99 "One transfer. Set up once. Calendar arrow showing the same automatic monthly transfer firing."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. '1 TRANSFER. SET UP ONCE.' — text IS the prop (only two lines, factual). Calendar strip below showing Tuesday → automatic arrow → next month → automatic arrow → next month. The automation repeats without decision. Alex not present — the system runs without him.

BEAT 100 "The Brain Villain is not defeated. It is bypassed."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Brain Villain inside Alex's skull: reclining, asleep — not gone, not defeated. Gentle ZZZ sleep icon above the Villain. The transfer arrow circles outside the skull, bypassing the Villain entirely. The Villain sleeps while the system works. This is the hack.

BEAT 101 "Alex calm. Arms crossed. Five circuits present but contained."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex in confident pose — arms crossed, expression calm and knowing. Inside skull: all five circuits still glowing, but surrounded by a clean structural boundary (the automatic transfer system acts as a container). Circuits present, not stopped. Alex at peace with it.

BEAT 102 "If your brain is doing this to you right now — subscribe."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Alex large in frame, direct eye contact with viewer. Brain Villain tiny beside him — small, not defeated, just contextualized. Below: subscribe button icon clean and simple. Alex expression: warm and direct. White background.

BEAT 103 "We break down a new bias every week. It is free. And it might save you more than you think."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Neurocents channel end frame. Clean white background. Alex and Brain Villain side by side — Alex calm, Villain contained. Channel name visual (no specific logo needed — just 'NEUROCENTS' text as the prop, clean bold). Simple, memorable close.

BEAT 104 *"Next video: the one decision that bypasses all five programs."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon Brain Villain, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, BLUE t-shirt (NOT RED — verify every time), gray pants. Brain Villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin #F5E6C8 · pink brain #E8A598 · electric blue shirt · gray pants · green: savings/gains · red: loss/danger · white: diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Preview card: forward arrow, TUESDAY calendar marker, single transfer icon. Alex pointing toward next video — expression: forward momentum. Curiosity gap: what is the one decision? Viewer must come back. Clean white background. Text: '1 DECISION / NEXT' as prop.

PART 4 DONE — Beats 79–104 ✓